

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Your résumé needs a great introduction!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe jobs and careers in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you think it's important to send a cover letter with your résumé?
- What kinds of things should be included in your cover letter?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about events and experiences related to a job.
- I can talk about issues related to a job search.
- I can explain how to write a cover letter.





Let's Explore!

Kristi needs a **five-star*** cover letter!

* "Five-star" is an adjective that means "excellent."



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Bianca: Hey Kristi! How was the workshop?

Kristi: It was good but I realize how much work has to be done. My résumé has to be tailored to each job I apply to and more action words are needed. The résumé isn't the only place where more work is needed.

Bianca: What do you mean?

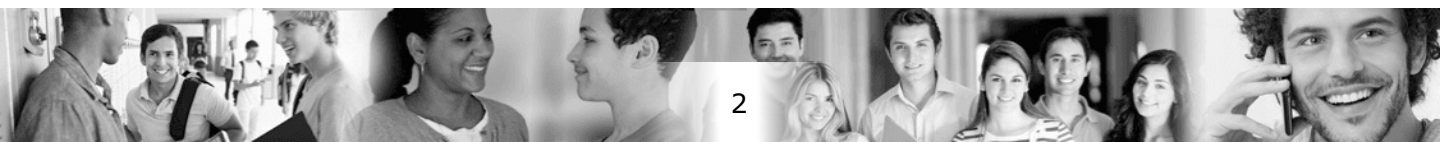
Kristi: A cover letter where a concise introduction is composed is crucial. They emphasized, when I did the workshop, that every cover letter must be sent with a résumé. Your cover letter should explain how the work experience listed on your résumé will make you a good candidate for the position or the company.

Bianca: Your cover letter is the document where you give a more personal introduction to yourself. So were the suggestions that were given at the workshop pertinent to writing a cover letter?

Kristi: Yes. We were given the fundamentals. The time when you draft a cover letter is the time to think about specific components. First, the letter should have four paragraphs. The first paragraph should state where you found the job lead and that you are applying for a particular job. If there is a job title or job posting number, you should include that as well. The second paragraph is a short profile which highlights your skills, experiences and achievements. The third paragraph states clearly how your specific abilities and skill sets would be valuable to the company and position. The fourth paragraph closes the letter. You should thank the company for their time and for reviewing your résumé. You should also say that you will follow up with a short call.

Bianca: Wow, there's a lot to include!

Kristi: And you also need to remember to research the company so you can address the letter to a specific person, including their title.





Let's Practice!

What words does Kristi use to talk about cover letters?

Instructions: Organize the mystery words. Read the words aloud. Compare your pronunciation with a partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) n / t / n / t. / e / e / P / r / i _____
- 2) t. / C / n / o / p / m / e / o / n _____
- 3) h / e / m / e / i / t. / n / c / v / e / A _____
- 4) e / t / u / a / n / a / d / l / s. / n / m / F _____
- 5) s / e. / o / C / o / p / m _____
- 6) t. / i / L / s _____
- 7) t / o / a / D / f / r / t. _____



Let's Practice!

Kristi has learned a lot about cover letters. Have you?

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentences from Column A to Column B.

Column A

- 1) The résumé isn't the only
- 2) The cover letter is the document
- 3) A cover letter where a
- 4) They emphasized when I did the workshop
- 5) The time when you draft a cover letter

Column B

- a) where you give a more personal introduction.
- b) that a cover letter must be sent with a resume.
- c) place where more work is needed.
- d) is the time to think about specific components.
- e) concise introduction is composed is crucial.





Extension Activity

Watch the TED Talk: "Cover Letter in 60 Seconds".

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, watch the TED Talk "Cover Letter in 60 Seconds".
- Take notes on all the tips you hear about writing a good cover letter.
- Write down any new vocabulary. Watch as many times as you need.
- Look up any unknown words in a dictionary.
- Using your notes, make a list of tips for someone who wants to write a cover letter.
- If possible, compare your list of tips with a partner who watched the same video.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch a video about cover letters.

☐
☐

I take notes while watching a video.

☐
☐

I look up new vocabulary in a dictionary.

☐
☐

I use my notes to make a list of tips.

☐
☐

I compare my list with a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- pertinent** (adjective): relating directly to the subject being considered
e.g. So were the suggestions that were given at the workshop pertinent to writing a cover letter?
- fundamentals** (noun): the basic information
e.g. We were given the fundamentals of writing a cover letter.
- to tailor** (verb): to change something to make it fit the situation
Example: My résumé is to be tailored to each job I apply to and more action words are needed.
- to draft** (verb): to write the first copy
e.g. The time when you draft a cover letter is the time to think about specific components.
- component** (noun): a part
e.g. There are several different components to a cover letter.
- achievement** (noun): an accomplishment
e.g. The second paragraph is a short profile which highlights your skills, experiences and achievements.
- title** (noun): a word that is used before someone's name, stating their social rank, position in an organization or gender
e.g. Address the letter to a specific person, including their title.
- to compose** (verb): to produce music, poetry, or formal writing
e.g. A cover letter where a concise introduction is composed is crucial.
- to list** (verb): to make a list, or to include something in a list
e.g. Your cover letter should explain how the work experience listed on your résumé will make you a good candidate for the position or the company.
- job lead** (noun): a piece of information about a possible job opportunity
e.g. The first paragraph should state where you found the job lead and that you are applying for a particular job.



Learning Points

Subject and Object Relative Clauses to Express Time and Place

When you want to clarify which person or thing you are talking about, you use a relative clause. You use relative clauses to give more information about the person, place or thing you are talking about. They are used to make sentences more complex.

You can begin a relative clause with *who* for people, *which* for things or *that* for either people or things.

You can begin a relative clause with *when* for time and *where* for place.

You put the relative clause immediately after the noun it talks about.

A **subject relative clause** describes the subject of the clause and comes after the subject of the sentence.

An **object relative clause** describes the object of the clause and comes after the object of the sentence.

Relative Adverbs

Relative adverbs are used like *relative pronouns*:

When = is used for a time: *The time when I went to the workshop.*

Where = is used for a place: *The workshop where I learned about cover letters.*

It was emphasized when I did the workshop.

(It was emphasized then.)

The cover letter is where you give a more personal introduction.

(You give a more personal introduction there.)

Example	Clause	Relative connector	Type of Relative Clause
<i>The résumé isn't the only place where more work is needed.</i>	<i>where more work is needed</i>	where	subject
<i>The time when you draft a cover letter is the time to think about specific components.</i>	<i>when you draft a cover letter</i>	when	subject

Examples:

- *The résumé isn't the only place where more work is needed.*





Learning Points

- *The cover letter is the document where you give a more personal introduction.*
- *A cover letter where a concise introduction is composed is crucial.*
- *The emphasis, when I did the workshop, was on how a cover letter must be sent with a résumé.*
- *The time when you draft a cover letter is the time to think about specific components.*

How to Write a Cover Letter

A cover letter must be sent with your résumé when you apply for a job. Below are some tips on how to write a great cover letter.

What goes into a good cover letter:

- **The Meet and Greet** (first paragraph)

Open by stating where or how you got the job lead, then say that you would like to apply for the job. If there is a job title or job posting number, you should include that as well. Give details on your skill sets, focusing on how they would qualify you for consideration. This will signal that you pay attention to details, and are professional. Be mindful of the language you use. It should demonstrate how well you write and communicate.

- **Your Skills and Experience** (second and third paragraphs)

Outline your skill sets, areas of expertise, and accomplishments that might be of interest to your prospective employer.

- **Getting the Interview** (fourth paragraph)

Explain as concisely as possible how you could be valuable both to the company and to the position. Demonstrate that you have researched the company by showing how what you have to offer is a strong match to the job description. Your goal is to make the company want to call you in for an interview.

Guidelines for Your Cover Letter

- Write one concise page
- After you write the first draft, revise and edit it
- To itemize skill sets, accomplishments, and job experience, use bullet points
- Simple formatting is always best
- Use a basic font like Arial or Verdana
- Find someone who can read through your cover letter and help you edit it before sending it

Examples:

- *A cover letter must be sent with a résumé.*
- *The letter should have four paragraphs.*





Learning Points

- *The first paragraph should state where you found the job lead and that you are applying for a particular job.*
- *The second paragraph is a short profile which highlights your skills, experiences and achievements.*
- *The third paragraph states clearly how your specific abilities and skill sets would be valuable to the company and position.*
- *The fourth paragraph closes the letter.*
- *You also need to remember to research the company so you can address the letter to a specific person, including their title.*

